

How the beef carcass grade gets decided

An executive overview of the scorecard behind Calibra's beef carcass grading — for leadership and grading-desk stakeholders.

Prepared 14 Sep 2026 Scope BG1021 (steer) — lamb & goat remain manual

Mode shadow (advisory)

6	0–18	5	6
visual attributes scored per carcass	Verdict 1 point range	carcass weight tiers	possible grade outcomes

How a carcass is graded

Every BG1021 carcass runs through the same five-step scorecard, worked from the reference grading sheet. Weight only enters the picture at step four — and only when it's actually needed.

- 01

QA scores six visual attributes — **Dentition, Fat Cover, Bruising/Blemishes, Fat Colour, Meat Colour, Muscle Conformation** — and the points sum to `Verdict 1`.
- 02

Verdict 1 is checked against every grade's scoring band. The bands **overlap by design** — FAQ and Standard, for instance, share the same floor of 10 — so one score can land inside more than one grade at once.
- 03

If only **one** grade's band fits, that's the classification. Settlement weight isn't consulted at all.
- 04

If more than one grade fits — a tie — carcass weight breaks it. Weight is banded into five tiers and can only ever pull the grade **down**, never up: `Verdict 2 = Verdict 1 + weight tier`, used purely to rank the tied candidates.

The system records its own suggestion alongside whatever QA finally saves — it never overwrites their call. That's **shadow mode**, below.

Points by attribute

What QA actually selects for each of the six attributes, and the points each option carries toward Verdict 1.

DENTITION		FAT COVER	
Full mouth	1	Marbling (heavy, well-marbled)	4
3 pairs	2	Good (3–10mm+, even)	3
2 pairs	3	Fair (2–7mm)	2
1 pair	3	Minimum/inadequate	1
Milk teeth	3	None (no discernible cover)	0
FAT COLOUR		MEAT COLOUR	
Creamish white	3	Bright red	2
Light yellow	2	Dark meat	1
Deep yellow	1		
BRUISING / BLEMISHES		MUSCLE CONFORMATION	
No bruises	3	Well finished (thick flesh)	3
Mild bruises	2	Fair conformation	2
Extensive bruises	1	Poor conformation	1
Severely bruised	1		
Cysts Bovis infestation	0		
Other discolouration	1		

Grade bands

Where each grade's Verdict 1 range sits, and the weight tier it needs if that range ties with another grade's.

GRADE	VERDICT 1 BAND	WEIGHT TIER REQUIRED
Premium	17–18	Tier 5 — 220kg and up
High Grade	13–17	Tier 4 — 170–219.9kg
FAQ	10–15	Tier 3 — 150–169.9kg
Standard	10–16	Tier 2 — 120–149.9kg
Commercial	8–14	Tier 1 — below 120kg
Poor C	0–7	No weight floor of its own

Weight only breaks the tie

Five bands, drawn straight from the reference sheet's weight table — the same tiers a carcass's grade can only ever be pulled down into, never up.

TIER 1	TIER 2	TIER 3	TIER 4	TIER 5
Commercial	Standard	FAQ	High Grade	Premium
below 120kg	120–149.9kg	150–169.9kg	170–219.9kg	220kg and up

SHADOW MODE

The scorecard computes `verdict1 / verdict2 / auto_classification` for every carcass and stores it alongside whatever grade QA actually saves — it suggests, never decides. Each saved row is tagged **auto** or **manual** depending on whether QA's own choice matched the suggestion, and a **tied** flag marks the rare case where weight couldn't clearly settle a tie between grades.

That agreement trail is what tells us when it's safe to let the system decide on its own — it isn't there yet.

Live for **BG1021 steer carcasses only**. Lamb and goat keep their existing manual grading, unchanged.

Prepared from the QA grading system · internal use

Accent ink echoes the violet, food-safe dye used on physical grade stamps